

It is also no secret that Speaker Jagadish Shettar may also be brought back to the ministerial fold; there are two vacancies currently.

But the biggest success story in establishing inter-state relations has been resolving Tamil poet Thiruvalluvar's statue controversy in Bangalore (and unveiling Kannada poet Sarvajna statue in Chennai) in August last month. This was a noteworthy achievement, considering the statue issue was lingering since 1991. As for the other

Muslim as a minister in his 34-member Cabinet. In addition, Catholic Archbishop Bernard Moras feels Yeddyurappa has not done enough for his community. The Catholic pontiff, who Yeddyurappa avoids after the former's public outburst when miscreants desecrated a church last year, is critical of the BJP Government's refusal to renew the lease of a 50-acre plot of government land at Sumanahalli near Bangalore which was offered to the Catholic community by chief minister Devraj Urs in 1977 for leprosy

There is a feeling that the doctors' stir was not handled effectively by Health Minister B. Sriramulu even as Yeddyurappa has called for a meeting with the doctors' body on October 4. The government physicians who have resigned say they are serving their notice period till October 14. The question then is—couldn't the leadership have solved this problem earlier?

Additionally, the Government's plan for an anti-conversion law, first of its kind in south India, would also be an acid test for the leadership. This

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HUMBLING IN THE RECENT BY-POLLS THAT GAVE THE BJP a majority on its own, the once formidable Congress and JD(s) leaders are trying hard to make their presence felt.

KUMARASWAMY (LEFT) WITH DEVE GOWDA (RIGHT); CONGRESS LEADERS MALLIKARJUN KHARGE, JANARDHAN POOJARY AND DHARAM SINGH

problems, he is quick in his defence. "Regarding the Cauvery or Hogenakkal water issues, I've said disputes can be resolved through dialogue," says Yeddyurappa.

Tamil Nadu Chief Minister M. Karunanidhi hailed him as his "younger brother", taking the cross-border relationship to new heights. Set for Assembly elections mid-October, the BJP in neighbouring Maharashtra wants Yeddyurappa to campaign among the Kannada-speaking voters in the state.

Minorities, on the other hand, have a major grouse: he has one

patients. Under the supervision of the Social Welfare Department now, the land now houses street kids, orphans, HIV patients and destitutes, cared for by the Catholic sisters and brothers. The Government is also planning to take over the 160-acre property housing the Beggars Colony adjacent to the leprosy home. More criticism is pouring in for Yeddyurappa for doling out a Rs 100-crore grant in March 2009 budget to some Hindu mutts.

A bigger battle for the Yeddyurappa Government revolves around the case of 3,800 government doctors resigning over lack of better pay.

is likely to increase the gulf between the Government and the Christian community which fears that the law may be used to arrest Christian leaders on fabricated charges.

Rubbishing the charges, Yeddyurappa maintains that he is a secular leader and insists that his only mission in life is "development, development and development". The question is—where is development? For the man in a hurry, there is much work to do. One hopes that the lessons from the third edition of the brainstorming session will provide him with right perspective. ■